

YEAR 9 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 2 · CLASSROOM LIFE & LEARNING

Reading

B2.1

Two Students, Two Favourite Subjects · A Guide to Smart Study Tools

Hazırlık Sonrası 9. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think Deniz's and Mira's favourite subjects will be, and why might they like them?
2. What is your own favourite subject, and what kind of learning activities does it usually involve?

Two Students, Two Favourite Subjects

- 1 Deniz has always loved Biology. Every week, her class does at least one hands-on activity — dissecting a flower, growing bacteria in a petri dish, or building a model of a cell. 'I remember facts much better when I've actually done something with my hands,' she explains. 'If a teacher just talks for forty minutes, I switch off after ten.' Deniz also keeps a set of flashcards with labelled diagrams, which she reviews for ten minutes every evening rather than cramming before a test.
- 2 Mira, on the other hand, is far more excited by Coding, an elective course she chose in Year 9. She enjoys the logical, step-by-step nature of writing a programme, and she likes that mistakes are simply part of the process — a wrong line of code just produces an error message, not a bad grade. Mira mostly studies using online tutorials and a mind-mapping app, which helps her see how different commands connect to each other before she starts typing.
- 3 Although Deniz and Mira are interested in completely different subjects, their stories share an important lesson: a subject feels enjoyable when the learning activities match the way a person naturally thinks. Some students learn best by doing, others by connecting ideas visually, and others by listening and discussing. Recognising your own learning style — and choosing study tools that fit it — can turn even a difficult subject into one you look forward to.

238 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main idea of the text?
☐ a Biology is more useful than Coding.
☐ b A subject feels enjoyable when the learning activities match how a student thinks.
☐ c Mira and Deniz study in exactly the same way.
2. Deniz's class does at least one _____ activity every week, such as dissecting a flower.
3. According to the text, Mira likes Coding partly because:
☐ a mistakes are simply part of the process, not a bad grade ☐ b it has no homework
☐ c it doesn't require any study tools
4. Deniz prefers to cram all her revision the night before a test. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
5. Mira uses a _____ app to see how different commands connect before she starts typing.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. Whose learning style is more similar to yours — Deniz's or Mira's? Why?

2. Write one sentence about a study tool that helps you learn your favourite subject.

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What study tools or apps do you already use to help you learn?

2. Do you think old tools like paper notebooks are still useful, or have digital tools replaced them completely?

A Guide to Smart Study Tools

- 1 Walk into almost any classroom today and you will find a mix of old and new study tools working side by side. Alongside the familiar exercise book and paper textbook, many students now use a digital textbook that highlights key vocabulary automatically, or a flashcard app that shows them a word

again just before they are likely to forget it. Teachers, too, increasingly rely on an interactive whiteboard to display diagrams, videos and quizzes that the whole class can respond to together.

- 2 One especially useful innovation is spaced repetition, the method behind many flashcard apps. Instead of reviewing everything the night before a test, students see each fact several times over a period of days or weeks, with longer gaps between each review. Research suggests that this approach helps information move from short-term to long-term memory far more effectively than last-minute cramming. Mind maps work on a similar principle: by connecting ideas visually, they make it easier to recall a whole topic rather than isolated facts.
- 3 However, no tool can replace regular practice and genuine understanding. A flashcard app can help you memorise vocabulary, but it cannot teach you to write a full paragraph; an interactive whiteboard can make a lesson more engaging, but students still need to take notes and think for themselves. The most effective students are usually not the ones with the most expensive gadgets, but the ones who choose a small number of tools that suit their own learning style and use them consistently.

248 words

2 While you read

4 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main purpose of this text?
 - a To argue that paper textbooks should disappear completely
 - b To explain different study tools and how to use them effectively
 - c To describe the history of the interactive whiteboard
2. The method behind many flashcard apps, which shows facts again after longer gaps, is called _____.
3. According to the text, the most effective students always own the most expensive gadgets.
☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
4. Why does the writer say 'no tool can replace regular practice'?
 - a Because study tools are not useful at all
 - b Because tools can help with some tasks, but students still need to practise and understand
 - c Because interactive whiteboards are too expensive for most schools

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Which study tool from the text would you like to try? Why?

2. Do you agree that 'no tool can replace regular practice'? Explain your opinion with an example.
